

Ireland



Area 27,135 sq miles
(70,280 sq km)

Population 4.5 million

Capital Dublin

Currency Euro

Official languages Irish
and English

Life expectancy 79 years



After centuries of struggle against British rule, the Irish Republic became a sovereign state in 1937. It covers about 85 percent of the island of Ireland (the rest remains part of the UK). The population is almost entirely ethnically Irish.

United Kingdom



Area 94,525 sq miles
(244,820 sq km)

Population 62.4 million

Capital London

Currency Pound sterling

Official languages English
and Welsh (in Wales)

Life expectancy 79 years



Belgium



Area 11,780 sq miles
(30,510 sq km)

Population 10.8 million

Capital Brussels

Currency Euro

Official languages Dutch,
French, and German

Life expectancy 79 years



Belgium is located between Germany, France, and the Netherlands. The south includes the forested Ardennes region. Belgium has two main communities—the majority Dutch-speaking Flemings and the French-speaking Walloons.



▲ BELGIAN CHOCOLATES

Belgian chocolates are considered to be some of the best chocolates in the world. They come in a variety of flavors, and are sold all over the world.

Jubilee in 2012, is the second-longest reigning queen in British history, after Queen Victoria (1837–1901). The UK heads the Commonwealth—an organization of 54 independent member states—is a world leader in financial services, and is home to many major multinational companies.

▼ RED MAILBOX

A traditional red Royal Mail box is mounted in front of a drystone wall in the Lake District, England.

